

Chapter-4

CONJUNCTIONS

Study the following sentences:

- (i) I went home *and* took my food.
- (ii) Give her a pen *or* a pencil.
- (iii) He is hard-working *but* not intelligent.
- (iv) I could not contact him *because* he was ill.
- (v) *Since* we have no money, we cannot buy a car.
- (vi) I talked to him *while* he was going to his office.
- (vii) He is so weak *that* he cannot walk.
- (viii) I shall come *if* you promise to keep quiet.

In all these sentences, the italicized words *join words or sentences*. They are *linking words* and are, therefore, called *conjunctions*, (or connectors).

Definition:- A *Conjunction* is a part of speech that *connects* words, clauses, or sentences, or shows relations between sentences.

Kinds of Conjunctions

Conjunctions can be classified into three types :

- 1. Co-ordinative Conjunctions
- 2. Subordinative Conjunctions
- 3. Correlative Conjunctions

(A) Co-ordinative Conjunctions

Study the following sentences:

- 1. (a) He has seen this house.
(b) He has decided to buy it.
(c) He has seen this house *and* has decided to buy it.
- 2. (a) Ram went to see the circus show.
(b) His brother stayed at home.
(c) Ram went to see the circus show *but* his brother stayed at home.
- 3. (a) He cannot write.
(b) He cannot read.

- (c) He cannot write *or* read.
- 4. (a) Go where you like.
- (b) Do not disturb me.
- (c) Go where you like, *only* do not disturb me.
- 5. (a) The hero was rewarded.
- (b) The hero was praised.
- (c) The hero was both praised *and* rewarded.

In each of the above five sets of sentences, sentences under (a) and (b) are *independent* of each other. They are joined in sentences under (c) by a Conjunction (italicized). Such Conjunctions are called *co-ordinative Conjunctions*.

Co-ordinative Conjunctions are those conjunctions that join words, phrases or clauses of *equal* rank.

Here are some examples:

1. Ram *and* Sham went to the market.
2. I did go there *but* I did not participate in the discussion.
3. Sonu is a coward *but* his brother is very brave.
4. You should ring up your mother, *for* she must be worried.
5. He is sick, *yet* he is always cheerful.
6. We went to Delhi *and* saw the zoo.
7. The Prime Ministers *as well as* the Home Minister paid a visit to the flood-hit areas.
8. He is better, *but* he does not attend the office.
9. Everybody opposed him; he, *however*, stuck to his plan.
10. You will succeed, *for* you are hardworking.

(B) Subordinative Conjunctions

Study the following sentences:

1. (a) The thief was caught red-handed.
- (b) He was stealing a jewellery box.
- (c) The thief was caught red-handed *while* he was stealing a jewellery box. (Time)
2. (a) She is extremely happy today.
- (b) She has been engaged to a boy of her choice.
- (c) She is extremely happy today *because* she has been engaged to a boy of her choice. (Reason)
3. (a) He continued gambling.
- (b) He lost all his money.
- (c) He continued gambling *till* he lost all his money. (Time)
4. (a) The students work hard.
- (b) They want to pass.

- (c) The students work hard *so that* they should pass. (Effect)
5. (a) It was quite cold.
 (b) She did not light a fire.
 (c) *Although* it was quite cold, *yet* she did not light a fire. (Contrast)

In all the above sets of sentences, sentences under (b) depend upon or are subordinate to the sentences under (a). They have been joined under (c) with the help of some conjunctions (in italics). Such Conjunctions are called Subordinative Conjunctions.

Subordinative Conjunctions are those conjunctions that join the Subordinate clause/clauses to the Principal clause. They generally indicate different relations in which the subordinate clause stands to the Principal Clause.

Here are some more examples:

1. He made a promise *that* he would behave better in future.
2. I shall try to help her *since* you desire it.
3. He will join the meeting *if* he is allowed to do so.
4. You cannot pass *unless* you work hard.
5. Let us go home *as* it is getting dark.
6. She will be able to win the scholarship *because* she is working very hard for it.
7. He is taking exercise regularly *in order that* he may improve his health.
8. The sun will shine *while* the world lasts.
9. The minister returned to the capital *after* he had delivered the speech.
10. The news is true *as far as* I know it.

Use of 'If' as Subordinate Conjunction

Read the following sentences and note how 'if' is used as a Subordinative Conjunction in various sentences:

A			
If	you go to Delhi		bring a camera for me.
	you like this colour		get three sets right now.
B			
If	she goes there		she will find things totally changed.
	I go to Kashmir		I shall bring some apples for you.
C			
If	you had gone there		you would have been in trouble.
	I had been the headmaster		I would have dismissed this foolish peon.
	she had worked hard		she would have passed.

(C) Correlative Conjunctions

Study the following sentences:

1. No sooner did he reach the station *than* the train steamed off.
2. Neither Sham *nor* his brother committed this crime.
3. He is so weak *that* he cannot walk.
4. She is *not only* beautiful *but* intelligent also.

In all the above sentences, Conjunctions are seen to occur in pairs such as no sooner than, *neither**nor*, *so* *that*, *not only* *but also*. Such Conjunctions are called *Correlative Conjunctions*.

Here are some examples to illustrate the use of some Correlative Conjunctions:

1. Neither nor :
 - (i) This book is *neither* useful *nor* cheap.
 - (ii) Ramesh can *neither* see *nor* hear.
2. Eitheror :
 - (i) *Either* you *or* your friend has stolen my book.
 - (ii) You can *either* play *or* work.
3. Not only..... but also :
 - (i) He is *not only* poor *but* honest *also*.
 - (ii) The cruel lady *not only* dismissed her servant *but also* got him arrested.
4. Though yet :
 - (i) *Though* he is rich, *yet* he is not mean.
 - (ii) *Though* he is quite hard-working, *yet* he could not pass.
5. Lest..... should :
 - (i) Walk carefully, *lest* you *should* stumble.
 - (ii) She is careful this time, *lest* she *should* fail again.
6. Both and:
 - (i) He is *both* handsome *and* sensible.
 - (ii) *Both* Sita *and* her sister were absent.
7. Such as:
 - (i) I love *such* students *as* are industrious.
 - (ii) He is *such* a fool *as* no one likes.
8. Asas, so.... as :
 - (i) Exercise is *as* necessary *as* food.
 - (ii) You do not love her *so* much *as* I do.

9. Scarcely before:
 - (i) We had *scarcely* reached the river *before* it started raining.
 - (ii) The leader had *scarcely* entered *before* the audience became restless.
10. Hardly when :
 - (i) They had *hardly* reached the school *when* the bell rang.
 - (ii) She had *hardly* stepped out *when* she got the sad news.
11. So that :
 - (i) He worked *so* hard *that* he won a scholarship.
 - (ii) He is *so* foolish *that* you cannot expect any sensible talk from him.
12. Whether or:
 - (i) It is all the same for me *whether* you take part in games *or* not.
 - (ii) I am going ahead with my plans *whether* I succeed *or* fail.
13. No sooner than :
 - (i) *No sooner* is the sky overcast *than* the peacock begins to dance.
 - (ii) *No sooner* did the thief see the policeman *than* he took to his heels.
14. The same that/as:
 - (i) This is the *same* man *that* came to my help.
 - (ii) It is *the same* kind of pen *as* mine.
15. Rather than :
 - (i) I shall *rather* starve *than* steal.
 - (ii) He would *rather* die *than* beg.

Use of Relative Pronouns as Connectors or Conjunctions

Study the following sentences:

1. (a) The farmer is very sad.
 (b) His crops were damaged.
 (c) The farmer, *whose* crops were damaged, is very sad.
2. (a) God helps those people.
 (b) They help themselves.
 (c) God helps those *who* help themselves.
3. (a) Listen to this.
 (b) Your teacher says something.
 (c) Listen to *what* your teacher says.
4. (a) Dr. Manmohan Singh is a very able administrator.
 (b) He was the Prime Minister of India.

- (c) Dr. Manmohan Singh, *who* was the Prime Minister of India, is a very able administrator.
5. (a) This building is very strong even today.
(b) It was constructed in 1870.
(c) This building, *which* was constructed in 1870, is very strong even today.
6. (a) The model was sold for rupees six hundred.
(b) I prepared this model.
(c) The model, *that* was prepared by me, was sold for rupees six hundred.

In each of these six sets of sentences, sentences under (a) and (b) have been combined into single sentences under (c) with the help of the italicized connectors. These connectors are *Relative Pronouns*.

Thus we see that Relative Pronouns can also act as Conjunctions in some cases.

Exercises for Practice

Exercise 1

Fill in the blanks with appropriate Connectors :

1. Ram would have helped her he had enough money.
2. Wisdom is better riches.
3. Sita had been waiting for 4 hours the train arrived.
4. Many are called few are chosen.
5. I ran fast I missed the train.
6. I would rather suffer apologize.
7. Wait I come back.
8. Let us go to bed it is twelve.
9. I would rather die tell a lie.
10. He likes her she is beautiful.

Exercise 2

Fill in the blanks with appropriate Connectors :

1. We eat we may live.
2. Men will reap they sow.
3. He ran he had been shot.
4. He is a rogue a fool.
5. you sow, shall you reap.

Exercise 3

Rewrite each of these pairs of simple sentences as one sentence using the Connectors given in the brackets:

1. You must start early. You will catch the train. (if)
2. They batted badly. They won the match. (although)
3. Their house is small. It is comfortable. (still)
4. Sign these papers. You'll get the loan. (if)
5. Tell me the truth. I shall punish you. (unless)

Exercise 4

Fill in the blanks with suitable Connector as given in the brackets :

1. I would have gone to the party I had been invited. (so that, although, if)
2. She went to the doctor she might be cured. (therefore, because, so that)
3. I shall wait for you you return. (unless, until)
4. She is a fine player she is so small. (because, although, unless)
5. The teacher punished him he had broken the window pane. (as, though)

Exercise 5

Fill in the blanks with appropriate Connectors :

1. She is beautiful not vain.
2. Though he is poor, he is honest.
3. He is neither an idler a gambler.
4. He had scarcely reached the school it began to rain.
5. A month has passed he came here.
6. Give me water to drink I shall die of thirst.
7. She is very honest she is poor.
8. I was so tired I at once fell asleep.
9. Make hay the sun shines.
10. He is neither hardworking intelligent.

Exercise 6

Pick out the Subordinate Conjunctions from the following sentences :

1. Let us go to bed as it is late now.
2. He studied hard in order that he might pass.
3. He carried a stick in his hand lest he should stumble.
4. He threatened to dismiss him unless he confessed his guilt.
5. He remained silent when he heard that.

6. We never understood why he behaved in that silly way.
7. We shall leave the class as soon as you start speaking.
8. He wished to know whether I was ready to accompany him.
9. If he is here, I shall call on him.
10. He was alarmed lest he should be taken in.

Exercise 7

Combine the following sets of sentences by using suitable Connectors :

1. It may rain. Take an umbrella.
2. Do not go out in this train. You may catch a cold.
3. Work hard. Otherwise you will fail.
4. It was raining hard. I stayed at home.
5. I eat. I am hungry.
6. You say so. I must believe it.
7. He is very poor. He is contented.
8. I am going to Delhi. I am expecting a merry time.
9. I did not listen to him. I failed badly.
10. You will succeed. You should work hard.

Exercise 8

Choose the correct conjunction given in brackets :

1. He tried hard (and, but) could not succeed.
2. He will not come (if, unless) you do not invite him.
3. He had died (before, after) the doctor came.
4. You will be late (if, unless) you hurry up.
5. You must see me (before, when) you leave for Delhi.
6. He worked hard (and, yet) he failed.
7. He is as clever (as, so) his father.
8. (Though, even if) he is my friend, I will not help him in this matter.

Exercise 9

Fill in the blanks with suitable Conjunctions :

1. I leave my bed the sun rises.
2. you say so that I shall proceed in the matter.
3. you walk fast, you will catch the train.

4. Work hard you may pass.
5. Walk carefully you should slip.
6. She is not so wise you think.
7. fast you may run, you cannot beat me in the race.
8. Though she worked hard, she could not top the list.
9. As you sow shall you reap.
10. He speaks he were my officer.

Exercise 10

Fill in the blanks selecting suitable words from those given in brackets :

1. The book you sent to me, is really interesting. (*that, who*)
2. The Chief Minister, is very popular with the masses, commands a great respect. (*that, who*)
3. This is the lady purse had been stolen. (*whom, whose*)
4. This is the house we want to purchase. (*that, who*)
5. The pen I like the most has been sold out. (*which, who*)
6. Varanasi is a city of temples is a place of pilgrimage for the Hindus. (*whose, which*)
7. The man she disliked came to her help in her hour of misery. (*who, whom*)
8. The bird sweet voice you heard every morning is no more. (*whose, whom*)
9. Can you identify the person abused you? (*whom, who*)
10. The prayer song we sing every day has been composed by my father. (*that, who*)

Exercise 11

Fill in the blanks with suitable Conjunctions :

1. It is a week the holidays began.
2. The crops will die the rains fall.
3. Work hard you should fail.
4. You will fail you do not put in proper efforts.
5. I shall be surprised you fail.
6. He took medicine he might get well.
7. You may not go out your work is done.
8. You can stay here you wish.
9. Wait here I return.
10. He went to the doctor he was ill.

Exercise 12

Fill in the blanks with suitable Conjunctions :

1. Leave the room; you will be caught.
2. Wise men love truth fools shun it.
3. She was found guilty she was punished.
4. He received a prize his brother was punished.
5. Don't make a noise I shall punish you.
6. He is a liar a cheat.
7. Trust in God do the right.
8. he is wrong I am wrong.
9. Ashok had no hope of success, he tried.
10. John was naughty ; I punished him.

Exercise 13

Fill in the blanks selecting the proper Subordinative Conjunctions from those given in brackets :

1. Tell me he has gone. (*as, nowhere, because, where*)
2. he satisfies me, he cannot get promotion. (*unless, if, because*)
3. The thief ran he saw the owner of the house. (*as soon as, as long as, how*)
4. Make hay the sun shines. (*while, before*)
5. He was late it was raining cats and dogs. (*as, how, when*)
6. Let us take lunch it is already twelve. (*as, so, while*)
7. He works hard he may win some position. (*in order that, lest, as*)
8. He is studying very hard he may top the list this time. (*as, because, so that*)
9. We eat we may live. (*so that, because, as if*)
10. He walked with care he should stumble. (*so that, lest, as*)

Exercise 14

Fill in the blanks with Subordinate Conjunctions :

1. He will join the meeting he is allowed to do so.
2. it was quite cold, yet she did not light a fire.
3. We eat we may live.
4. The sun will shine the world lasts.
5. He continued gambling he lost all his money.
6. She is extremely happy she has been engaged to a boy of her choice.
7. He will not pass he works hard.
8. The thief was caught red-handed he was stealing a jewellery box.

Exercise 15

Join the following pairs of sentences into single sentences using the Subordinative Conjunctions given in brackets:

1. You must leave the room. (whether)
You may wish it or not.
2. He is honest. (though)
He is a poor man.
3. You wish it. (since)
I shall help him.
4. He talked so much. (that)
He made himself hoarse.
5. He will succeed. (because)
He is working hard.
6. We called at his house. (as)
The clock struck four.
7. There is a will. (where)
There is a way.
8. He returned home. (after)
The rain had stopped.
9. The patient had died. (before)
The doctor came.
10. I called on him. (when)
He was at home.

Exercise 16

Fill in the blanks with the suitable Conjunctions :

1. Hardly had he gone there it started raining.
2. He is both a painter a singer.
3. Life is such a puzzle cannot be solved.
4. I am so tired I cannot walk.
5. He is as tired you are.
6. Not only is he rich but generous
7. He is not only anxious to acquire knowledge eager to display it.
8. His action was either just unjust.
9. Hardly had I reached the station the train started.
10. Scarcely had I arrived there all the visitors dispersed.

Exercise 17

Fill in the blanks with suitable Conjunctions :

1. Wait here I come back.
2. I like him he is honest.
3. We must eat we shall die.
4. You will never pass you do not work hard.
5. He failed he did not work hard.
6. He is very wise he is young.
7. Either take it leave it.
8. Work hard you will fail.
9. I would rather die yield.
10. I know he will come.

Exercise 18

Fill in the blanks with suitable Conjunctions :

1. Pinky was happy she passed the test.
2. You can do much better you try harder.
3. Always brush your teeth a meal.
4. I will not let you go you confess.
5. The children waited their mother come.
6. I have been living here 1990.
7. Make hay the sun shines.
8. He failed he tried again.
9. Walk quickly you will miss the train.
10. Cats can climb trees dogs cannot.